



single horn averages 10 in
(25 cm) in both sexes

Indian rhinoceros

Rhinoceros unicornis

Of all five rhinoceros species, the Indian rhino is second in size only to Africa's white rhino. It is also the one most at home in water—a trait seemingly at odds with its appearance. Its skin is 3 in (8 cm) thick and develops deep folds speckled with lumps, giving it an armor-plated look. Nevertheless, Indian rhinos are good swimmers and like to wallow. They are also surprisingly agile on land, able to turn quickly and charge at high speed. Since they have relatively poor eyesight, Indian rhinos rely on keen hearing and an excellent sense of smell to navigate their surroundings. A semiprehensile upper lip makes them adept at grasping grass stems.

Still at risk

Due to stricter protection laws, Indian rhino numbers have recovered from fewer than 200 in the early 20th century to more than 3,000 in the wild. Poaching, however, is still a problem, despite the fact that the Indian rhino's horn—which it uses mainly for foraging—is relatively small.

- ↔ 11 ft (3.4–3.5 m)
- ⚖ 4,400 lb (2,000 kg)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🌿 Grasses, shrubs, fruit
- 🏠 🌳 🌾 🌾 🌾



S. Asia (Terai and Brahmaputra basins)

